VTU MBA – FIRST SEMESTER

MANAGERIAL COMMUNICATION

MODULE 3: WRITTEN COMMUNICATION

Expanded study notes | Frameworks • Examples • Business letters • Cases • VTU questions

Course Code: 3MBA106 | Scheme: 2026 | Semester: I | Module Duration: 9 Hours

Syllabus coverage: Purpose of writing; clarity; principles of effective writing; the 3×3 writing process (prewriting, writing and revising); audience analysis; positive, neutral, persuasive and bad-news messages; business letters and types; routine and persuasive letters; positive and negative messages; employee reviews; recommendation letters; thank-you letters.

Reference basis: The supplied notes identify P. D. Chaturvedi and Mukesh Chaturvedi as the primary conceptual reference, supported by Mary Ellen Guffey and other business-communication texts for the 3×3 writing process and practical writing formats. The original terminology and organization have been retained.

1. Business Writing: Meaning and Nature

Business writing is purposeful written communication used in organizations and business relationships to inform, request, explain, persuade, document decisions, give instructions or maintain goodwill. It is designed to achieve understanding or a desired response efficiently and appropriately for its audience.

1.1 Characteristics of business writing

- Purposeful: Every message is written to achieve an identifiable objective such as informing, requesting, persuading or documenting.
- Economical: The writer uses the words and details necessary to communicate the message without unnecessary repetition.
- Audience-oriented: Content, tone, organization and level of detail are selected according to the reader.
- Clear and precise: The reader should not have to guess what the message means or what action is required.
- Documentable: A written message can provide a record of instructions, decisions, commitments and transactions.
- Professional: Language and tone should suit the purpose, relationship and organizational context.

1.2 Why business writing is important

Importance	Explanation	Example
Creates a record	Documents decisions, instructions, approvals and commitments.	A written confirmation of agreed delivery dates.
Supports coordination	Communicates responsibilities and deadlines across teams.	A project update specifying task owners and due dates.
Improves consistency	The same information can be shared with several people.	A policy circular sent to all employees.
Builds relationships	Courteous and well-structured messages create trust and goodwill.	A specific thank-you letter to a customer.
Supports decisions	Presents facts, evidence and recommendations in an organized form.	A proposal requesting budget approval.
Reduces ambiguity	Precise wording helps prevent different interpretations.	A purchase order specifying quantity, price and delivery terms.

2. Purpose of Writing

The purpose of writing is the result the writer wants to achieve through the message. The supplied Chaturvedi-based notes emphasize informing and persuading as central purposes, while business writing also commonly requests action, documents transactions and maintains goodwill.

Purpose	What the writer wants to achieve	Example
Inform	Provide facts, procedures, explanations or results.	Inform employees about a revised travel policy.
Persuade	Influence a decision, belief or action.	Convince management to approve analytics training.

Request / obtain action	Ask for information, approval, service or a specific action.	Request a supplier to replace defective equipment.
Document	Create a reliable written record.	Confirm agreed commercial terms after a meeting.
Maintain goodwill	Strengthen a professional relationship.	Thank a customer for a long-standing partnership.

Key distinction: A message may serve more than one purpose. For example, a proposal informs the reader about a problem and persuades the reader to approve a solution.

3. Clarity in Writing

Clarity means that the reader can understand the intended meaning without unnecessary interpretation. Clear writing uses simple language, precise words, logical organization and an explicit statement of the required action.

Writing problem	Weak example	Clearer version / correction
Vagueness	Please do the needful soon.	Please send the revised budget by 4 p.m. today.
Wordiness	At this point in time, we are in the process of reviewing the proposal.	We are reviewing the proposal.
Buried main point	Several background details appear before the decision or request.	State the decision or purpose early when a direct approach is appropriate.
Unclear pronoun	The manager told the analyst that he was late.	The manager told the analyst that the analyst was late.
Jargon	We need to leverage synergies ASAP.	The two teams need to combine their data by Friday.
Overloaded sentence	Several different actions are joined in one long sentence.	Separate distinct ideas and actions into shorter sentences.

3.1 A practical clarity test

After reading a business message, a busy reader should be able to answer four questions:

- What happened or what is being communicated?
- Why does it matter?
- What does the reader need to do?
- By when must the action be completed?

3.2 Before-and-after example

Unclear: “Please look into the pending matter and take necessary action at the earliest.”

Clear: “Please review the 14 pending customer complaints and send the resolution plan to the service manager by 2 p.m. on Thursday.”

The revised sentence identifies the task, quantity, recipient and deadline.

4. Principles of Effective Writing

The supplied Chaturvedi text explicitly emphasizes accuracy, brevity and clarity. It also discusses simplicity, standard or neutral language, you-attitude, sincerity and tone, and emphasis in business letters and memos. Guffey reinforces clarity, conciseness, conversational-professional language and adaptation to the audience.

Principle	Meaning	Practical application
Accuracy	Facts, figures, grammar, punctuation, spelling and word choice must be correct.	Verify names, dates, amounts, statistics and claims before sending.
Brevity	Remove unnecessary words without removing essential meaning.	Delete repetition, fillers and irrelevant background.
Clarity	The intended meaning should be immediately understandable.	Use familiar words, specific terms and logical structure.
Simplicity	Prefer straightforward language over unnecessarily complex expressions.	Use short sentences where appropriate and explain technical terms.
Conciseness	Every sentence should contribute to the purpose.	Ask whether a sentence can be shortened without losing meaning.
Appropriate tone	Tone should fit the purpose, relationship and situation.	Correct an error without sounding hostile or insulting.
Standard / neutral language	Use professional language understood by the intended audience.	Avoid slang and unnecessarily ornate expressions.
Audience orientation / you-attitude	Write from the reader's perspective and show why the message matters to them.	Explain the benefit or relevance to the reader.
Emphasis	Place important ideas where readers are likely to notice them.	Put the main idea first when direct organization is suitable.
Positive language	Frame feasible actions positively without hiding facts.	“We can ship on 1 June” rather than “We cannot ship before 1 June.”

4.1 The you-attitude

You-attitude means presenting information from the reader's point of view rather than focusing unnecessarily on the writer or organization. It does not mean using the word “you” repeatedly. It means considering the reader's needs, interests and likely reaction.

Writer-centred wording	Reader-centred wording
We have changed our process to reduce our workload.	The revised process will help you receive updates more quickly.
We cannot accept your form because it is incomplete.	Please add the missing signature so that your form can be processed.
We are pleased to announce our new service.	You can now track your service request online.

Core memory point: Accuracy + Brevity + Clarity are the three core principles explicitly highlighted in the supplied Chaturvedi notes. Simplicity, tone, audience orientation and emphasis strengthen the answer.

5. The 3 × 3 Writing Process

The 3×3 writing process divides business writing into three phases, each containing three activities. It provides a systematic way to plan, prepare and improve a written message.

PREWRITING: ANALYZE → ANTICIPATE → ADAPT

WRITING / DRAFTING: RESEARCH → ORGANIZE → DRAFT

REVISING: EDIT → PROOFREAD → EVALUATE

Phase	Activity	What happens
Prewriting	Analyze	Define the purpose, desired reader response and suitable communication channel.
Prewriting	Anticipate	Profile the audience and consider its knowledge, needs, attitude and likely reaction.
Prewriting	Adapt	Choose content, tone, language, detail and organization to suit the audience.
Writing / Drafting	Research	Collect facts, evidence, figures and required information.
Writing / Drafting	Organize	Choose a logical order and decide whether a direct or indirect strategy is suitable.
Writing / Drafting	Draft	Prepare the first version, concentrating on ideas and structure.
Revising	Edit	Improve clarity, conciseness, tone, organization and readability.
Revising	Proofread	Check spelling, grammar, punctuation, names, numbers, attachments and format.
Revising	Evaluate	Ask whether the message will achieve its purpose and produce the required reader response.

5.1 Understanding the three phases

Prewriting

Prewriting is the planning phase. The writer identifies the objective, considers the audience and adapts the message before drafting.

Writing / drafting

During drafting, the writer gathers relevant information, arranges it in a logical sequence and prepares the first version. The first draft need not be perfect; its purpose is to put the message into a workable form.

Revising

Revising improves the message before it is sent. It includes editing meaning and structure, proofreading surface errors and evaluating whether the message is suitable for its purpose and reader.

Important distinction: Revising is not merely proofreading. Proofreading catches surface errors; revising can change the content, order, tone, emphasis and likely impact on the reader.

5.2 Worked example: Budget approval request

Situation: A student club requests approval for ₹60,000 to conduct an analytics workshop.

3×3 activity	Application to the example
Analyze	Purpose: obtain approval. Desired response: approve ₹60,000 for the workshop.
Anticipate	The decision-maker may ask about learning value, expected attendance, cost and alternatives.
Adapt	Use a formal but concise tone; explain educational value and budget clearly.
Research	Collect speaker quotation, participant estimate, venue cost and alternative quotations.
Organize	Arrange the message as purpose → benefits → budget → cost controls → approval requested.
Draft	Prepare the first version of the request.
Edit	Remove repetition, strengthen evidence and improve tone.
Proofread	Check the amount, date, speaker's name and attachments.
Evaluate	Check whether the decision-maker has enough information to approve or reject the request.

Possible closing sentence: “I request approval for a budget of ₹60,000 for the workshop scheduled for 18 November, with registration capped at 70 students.”

The supplied notes cite a rough planning guide of 25% prewriting, 25% drafting and 50% revising. This is a practical guide attributed to Guffey, not a fixed rule; complex messages may require different allocations.

6. Audience Analysis

Audience analysis is the systematic process of understanding the intended reader before writing. It helps the writer adapt the purpose, content, organization, tone, channel and level of detail.

Audience factor	Question to consider	Effect on writing
Role / status	Who will read the message?	Determines formality, authority and level of explanation.
Knowledge	What does the reader already know?	Avoids over-explaining or under-explaining.
Interest	Why should the reader care?	Highlights the benefit, problem or relevance.
Attitude	Is the reader supportive, neutral or resistant?	Influences direct, neutral or persuasive organization.
Decision power	Can the reader approve or act on the request?	Makes the requested decision or action explicit.
Time	How much attention can the reader give?	Encourages concise wording, headings and bullets.

6.1 The WIIFM test

WIIFM means “What's in it for me?” The writer considers what the reader needs or values and makes the relevance of the message clear. A reader is more likely to engage when the message explains how it affects them.

6.2 Example of audience adaptation

Audience	How the same proposal may be adapted
Finance manager	Emphasize cost, return, budget controls and financial risk.
Technical manager	Explain system requirements, feasibility, dependencies and implementation.
Employees	Explain how the change affects daily work, responsibilities and support.
Customer	Emphasize customer benefits, service impact, cost and next steps.

Key point: Audience analysis is not simply guessing what a reader likes. It is a systematic assessment of the reader's role, knowledge, needs, attitude, authority and available time.

7. Message Types and Organization

Business messages can be classified by their purpose and the response expected from the reader. The supplied notes group them as positive, neutral or routine, persuasive, and bad-news or negative messages.

Message type	Typical purpose	Typical organization
Positive	Give good news, approval, acceptance or appreciation.	Usually direct: main idea → details → action or pleasant close.
Neutral / routine	Request or provide routine information or action.	Usually direct: main idea → details → close.
Persuasive	Influence someone to accept an idea, approve a proposal or take action.	Reader need/problem → benefits and evidence → response to concerns → action.
Bad-news / negative	Communicate refusal, limitation or disappointing information.	Direct or indirect approach depending on the situation; give truthful reasons and protect goodwill.

Important qualification: Do not treat one bad-news formula as compulsory for every situation. The appropriate organization depends on the audience, severity of the news, expectations and relationship.

8. Positive and Neutral Messages

Positive messages communicate favorable information such as approval, acceptance, appreciation or good news. Neutral or routine messages communicate everyday information, requests or actions. Both generally use a direct or deductive approach because the reader is likely to welcome the information or has no strong reason to resist it.

Message	Opening	Body	Closing
Positive / good-news	State the good news early.	Provide details, conditions and useful information.	Use a positive close, appreciation or next step.
Routine request	State what is required.	Give necessary context and details.	Specify the response or date and thank the reader.
Routine claim / adjustment	State the requested adjustment early when reasonable and supported.	Provide facts supporting the request.	State the next step and maintain a courteous tone.

8.1 Example: Positive message

Subject: Confirmation of Replacement Unit

Dear Ms. Rao,

We are pleased to confirm that your replacement unit will be dispatched on Tuesday, 12 November. The replacement includes the upgraded adapter requested in your service ticket.

Please keep the defective unit ready for pickup. Our logistics partner will contact you to confirm the collection time.

Thank you for your patience.

Regards,

Customer Support Team

8.2 Example: Routine request

Subject: Request for Updated Vendor Quotation

Dear Mr. Kumar,

Please share the updated quotation for 50 laptop docking stations by 5 p.m. on Thursday. Kindly include unit price, applicable taxes, delivery charges, warranty period and expected delivery date.

We require the quotation to complete the purchase approval process. Thank you for your assistance.

Regards,

Procurement Department

9. Persuasive Messages and Letters

A persuasive message seeks a specific action or a change in belief, opinion or behaviour. It should be based on a clear understanding of the reader, a relevant need or problem, credible evidence and a specific request.

9.1 Elements of an effective persuasive message

Element	Question addressed
Attention / problem	What issue or opportunity matters to the reader?
Need / relevance	Why should the reader care about this issue?

Benefits and evidence	What facts, examples or benefits support the proposal?
Response to concerns	What legitimate objections may the reader raise?
Action	Exactly what should the reader do, and by when?

9.2 Principles of persuasive writing

- Understand the reader's needs, interests, authority and likely objections.
- Present a problem or opportunity that is relevant to the reader.
- Explain benefits from the reader's point of view.
- Support claims with reliable facts, examples, comparisons or evidence.
- Address reasonable objections honestly rather than ignoring them.
- Make the requested action specific and easy to understand.
- Use a confident, courteous and professional tone; avoid pressure or exaggerated claims.

9.3 Example: Persuasive letter

Situation: A supplier has received an order for Model A, but Model B is available and offers additional features at a higher price.

Subject: Alternative Product Available for Your Order

Dear Ms. Shah,

Thank you for placing your order for Model A. We would like to bring Model B to your attention as an alternative that is currently available for immediate dispatch.

Model B includes 8 GB additional memory, a longer warranty and faster charging. Its price is ₹3,000 higher than Model A. If performance and extended warranty coverage are important for your requirements, Model B may offer better long-term value and avoid the wait for the next Model A shipment.

Please let us know whether you would like to retain your original order or consider Model B. We will proceed according to your confirmation.

Regards,

Sales Manager

9.4 Why the message is persuasive

- It acknowledges the customer's original order.
- It explains relevant benefits rather than listing every feature.
- It discloses the price difference clearly.
- It avoids unsupported claims and high-pressure language.
- It gives the customer a clear choice and next step.

10. Bad-News / Negative Messages

A bad-news message communicates an unfavorable decision, refusal, limitation or disappointing information. The writer must be truthful and clear while considering the reader's likely reaction and the need to maintain goodwill.

Approach	When it may be suitable	Typical organization
Direct	The negative matter is routine or minor; the reader expects a direct answer; or the decision must be stated clearly at once.	Decision / refusal → reason and necessary details → action or alternative.
Indirect	The reader is likely to be disappointed, expects a positive answer, or the relationship requires careful explanation.	Relevant context or neutral opening → reasons → decision → alternative or positive close where appropriate.

10.1 Principles for communicating bad news

- Be truthful; do not conceal the actual decision behind meaningless paragraphs.
- Give a clear and relevant explanation supported by facts or policy.
- Use tactful and respectful language without creating false hope.
- Choose a direct or indirect organization according to the situation, not by habit.
- Where possible, offer a reasonable alternative or explain the next available option.
- Maintain goodwill without weakening or misrepresenting the decision.

10.2 Example: Direct bad-news message

Subject: Request for Additional Programme Seat

Dear Mr. Rao,

The programme has reached its approved capacity of 60 participants, so we cannot add another seat for this intake. The capacity limit is required to maintain the planned trainer-to-participant ratio.

We can place your name first on the waiting list and contact you if a seat becomes available. Alternatively, we can share the dates of the next session when registration opens.

Thank you for your interest and understanding.

Regards,

Programme Coordinator

10.3 Example: Indirect bad-news message

Subject: Update on Your Refund Request

Dear Ms. Iyer,

Thank you for sharing the details of your purchase and the issue with the product. We understand the inconvenience this has caused.

Our standard refund period is 30 days from the date of purchase. As the request was received after 45 days, it falls outside the normal refund window. However, you have reported a manufacturing defect, so we would like to assess the product under the applicable warranty and quality process.

Please share the product serial number and a copy of the invoice so that our service team can review the case and confirm the available remedy.

Regards,

Customer Relations Team

Tact is not deception: A reader should understand the real decision and its reason. Courtesy should not create false hope or hide material facts.

11. Business Letters: Meaning, Need and Structure

A business letter is a formal written communication used for external or formal organizational transactions. Letters remain useful when a permanent record, formality, customer relationship, supplier communication or contractual documentation is important.

11.1 Need for business letters

- To communicate formally with customers, suppliers, government offices and other organizations.
- To make requests, place orders, seek information or submit claims.
- To communicate decisions, approvals, refusals and confirmations.
- To create a record of important business transactions and commitments.
- To maintain professional relationships and goodwill.

11.2 Parts of a business letter

Part	Purpose
Letterhead / sender details	Identifies the organization and sender.
Date	Establishes the timing of the communication and supports record keeping.
Receiver's details	Identifies the recipient and delivery context.
Subject / reference	Helps the reader identify the purpose quickly.
Salutation	Provides a professional opening.
Opening paragraph	States the purpose or main idea.
Body	Provides details, evidence, terms, explanation or requested action.
Closing paragraph	States the next step and maintains goodwill.
Complimentary close	Provides a courteous formal ending.
Signature block	Identifies the sender, designation and contact details.

11.3 General business-letter format

[Sender's letterhead / address]

[Date]

[Receiver's name, designation and address]

Subject: [Short description of the purpose]

Dear [Name / Sir / Madam],

[Opening paragraph: state the purpose or main message.]

[Body paragraph(s): provide relevant facts, details, explanation and requested action.]

[Closing paragraph: state the next step, deadline or courteous close.]

Yours sincerely / faithfully,

[Signature]

[Name]

[Designation / Organization]

11.4 Features of a good business letter

- Clear purpose and relevant subject line.
- Correct names, dates, amounts, references and supporting details.
- Logical arrangement of opening, body and closing.
- Professional tone and appropriate level of formality.
- Concise language without omitting necessary facts.
- Explicit request, decision or next step.
- Consistent formatting and careful proofreading.

12. Types of Business Letters

Business letters are most usefully classified according to their purpose. The syllabus does not require memorizing an arbitrary number of letter types; it is more useful to explain the purpose and give an example.

Type	Purpose	Typical example
Inquiry letter	Seek information.	Ask a supplier for price, specifications and delivery details.
Request letter	Ask for an action or service.	Request replacement under warranty.
Order letter	Place an order for goods or services.	Purchase 100 units of a product.
Claim / adjustment letter	Seek correction of a legitimate problem.	Request refund or replacement for defective goods.
Good-news / acceptance letter	Communicate approval or a favorable response.	Confirm acceptance of a service request.
Negative / refusal letter	Communicate an unfavorable decision.	Decline a request that does not meet stated conditions.
Persuasive / sales letter	Influence a purchase or other action.	Recommend an alternative product that better meets customer needs.
Recommendation letter	Support a person's application or selection.	Recommend a student for an internship.
Thank-you / appreciation letter	Express genuine appreciation.	Thank a speaker, customer or employee.

Employment-related letter	Communicate employment decisions or actions.	Offer, acceptance, rejection or follow-up letter.

12.1 Routine letter: warranty replacement request

Subject: Request for Replacement Battery under Warranty

Dear Customer Support Manager,

Please arrange a replacement battery for the laptop purchased on 14 September under invoice INV-2147. The battery currently holds charge for approximately 20 minutes, although the laptop has been used under normal conditions.

The product is within its one-year warranty period. A copy of the invoice and the warranty details are enclosed for reference.

Please confirm the replacement schedule and any steps required to return the defective battery. Thank you for your assistance.

Yours faithfully,

A. Kumar

12.2 Why this routine letter works

- The requested action is stated clearly at the beginning.
- Relevant facts support the request.
- The warranty and invoice information help the recipient verify the claim.
- The closing identifies the response required.

13. Positive and Negative Messages: Comparison

Positive message	Negative message
The receiver expects or welcomes favorable information.	The receiver may resist or feel disappointed.
The main idea can usually appear immediately.	The message may need context and reasons before or alongside the decision.
A direct strategy is usually effective.	A direct or indirect strategy may be appropriate depending on the situation.
The goal is efficient communication and goodwill.	The goal is clarity, truthful explanation and minimizing unnecessary damage to goodwill.

14. Employee Reviews

An employee review is a written assessment of an employee's work performance, contributions and development needs over a specified period. The supplied notes emphasize evidence-based, specific and development-oriented writing.

14.1 Elements of an effective employee review

Element	What to include	Example
Performance area	Identify the responsibility or competency being reviewed.	Customer issue resolution.
Evidence	Use observable results, behaviour or measurable outcomes.	Reduced average resolution time from 30 to 18 hours.
Strength	State what the employee does well.	Consistently follows through with customers.
Development area	Identify a specific improvement need.	Needs to document root-cause analysis more consistently.
Action	Specify what should change or be done.	Use the standard RCA template for every priority-1 incident.
Success measure	Define how improvement will be assessed.	90% of priority-1 incidents have complete RCA within 48 hours.

14.2 Good and poor employee-review wording

Poor wording	Improved evidence-based wording
Ravi is careless.	In three of the last five project submissions, supporting test evidence was incomplete.
She has a bad attitude.	During two client escalations, the response was delayed beyond the agreed service target.
Excellent employee.	Consistently meets project deadlines and resolves customer issues within the agreed service level.
Needs to be more responsible.	Use the evidence checklist before each submission; the target is 100% completeness over the next two months.

14.3 What to avoid

- Vague praise such as “excellent employee” without supporting examples.
- Personality labels such as “lazy”, “careless” or “irresponsible”.
- Unsupported criticism or claims based on assumptions.
- Discriminatory, insulting or emotionally charged language.
- Surprise negative feedback that has not been discussed during the review period.

Key principle: Separate observable performance from assumptions about personality. Strong employee reviews describe evidence, impact, development action and a measurable outcome.

15. Recommendation Letters

A recommendation letter is a formal letter written by a person who can comment credibly on a candidate's abilities, performance or suitability for an opportunity such as admission, employment, internship, scholarship or professional development.

15.1 Structure of a recommendation letter

Part	Content
Relationship / context	Explain how and in what capacity the writer knows the candidate and for how long.
Relevant capability	Identify skills and qualities relevant to the target opportunity.
Evidence	Describe what the candidate actually did, with examples or results.
Comparative / impact statement	Where appropriate, indicate the significance of the candidate's contribution without exaggeration.
Recommendation	State clearly whether the writer recommends the candidate and for what opportunity.
Contact	Provide a professional way to verify the recommendation, where appropriate.

15.2 Sample recommendation letter

[Institution / Organization Letterhead]

[Date]

To

The Internship Selection Committee

[Organization]

Subject: Recommendation for Ms. Ananya Rao – Marketing Internship

Dear Members of the Selection Committee,

I am pleased to recommend Ms. Ananya Rao for the Marketing Internship at your organization. I have taught Ananya in the MBA programme and have observed her academic work and participation in team assignments over the past year.

Ananya has demonstrated strong research and presentation skills. In a recent market-study project, she coordinated a four-member team, analyzed customer survey responses and presented practical recommendations supported by data. She completed the work within the agreed timeline and responded constructively to feedback.

Based on these observations, I believe she would contribute positively to an internship that requires research, teamwork and communication. I recommend her for your consideration.

Please contact me if further information is required.

Yours sincerely,

[Name]

[Designation]

[Institution]

15.3 Ethical considerations

- Recommend only what can be honestly supported by direct knowledge or reliable evidence.
- Do not invent achievements, skills, rankings or personal qualities.
- Select examples relevant to the opportunity.
- Obtain the candidate's permission where appropriate before sharing personal or confidential information.
- Use fair, professional and non-discriminatory language.

16. Thank-You Letters

A thank-you letter is a written message expressing genuine appreciation for a contribution, service, support, meeting, interview or professional interaction. An effective thank-you message is sincere, specific and connected to the contribution received.

16.1 Elements of an effective thank-you letter

- Identify the person or contribution being appreciated.
- Refer to the specific event, meeting, interview or assistance.
- Explain why the contribution was valuable.
- Use a sincere and appropriate tone.
- Where relevant, mention a future connection or next step.

16.2 Weak and improved wording

Generic wording	Specific wording
Thank you for your valuable support.	Thank you for reviewing our internship proposal and identifying the budget risk before submission.
Thanks for taking the time.	I appreciated your explanation of the customer-retention problem and the data you shared.
It was very helpful.	Your suggestion to segment the survey by customer tenure changed the way we analyzed the results.

16.3 Sample thank-you letter after a professional interaction

Subject: Thank You for the Discussion

Dear Ms. Menon,

Thank you for meeting with our MBA students on 12 November and sharing your experience in digital marketing. Your explanation of how organizations use customer data to improve campaign decisions was particularly useful.

The examples from your work helped students connect classroom concepts with current industry practices. We appreciate the time you gave to the session and hope to stay connected for future learning interactions.

Warm regards,

[Name]

[Designation / Institution]

16.4 Interview follow-up thank-you message

Subject: Thank You – Interview for Marketing Associate Role

Dear Mr. Shah,

Thank you for speaking with me about the Marketing Associate role on 12 November. I appreciated our discussion about customer segmentation and the team's approach to campaign measurement.

The conversation strengthened my interest in the position. Please let me know if I can provide any further information.

Regards,

[Candidate Name]

17. Integrated Case Studies

Case 1: Delayed Product Launch

A company planned to launch a student-finance application on 1 December. Testing has uncovered a critical security issue. The launch must move to 20 December. Marketing has already announced 1 December publicly.

Issues for analysis: The internal message to engineering and operations should confirm the revised plan; the message to marketing should explain the delay; the request to the CEO should justify additional testing resources; and the thank-you message should recognize the security team's contribution.

Suggested analysis: Each message has a different audience and purpose. The revised plan is a neutral or positive internal update; the delay is bad news for marketing; the request for resources is persuasive; and the appreciation note is a thank-you message. Audience analysis and message strategy should therefore differ.

Case 2: The Customer Refusal

A customer requests a refund 45 days after purchase. Company policy permits refunds within 30 days, but the product has a confirmed manufacturing defect. The customer is angry.

Suggested analysis: The confirmed defect is an important fact and should not be ignored. A policy-only refusal may damage goodwill and may fail to address the defect. The writer should distinguish the normal refund period from the warranty or quality process, explain the actual decision and offer a fair remedy if permitted by company policy.

Case 3: Employee Review

An employee completes projects on time but frequently submits documentation with missing evidence. The manager writes: “Ravi is careless and needs to become more responsible.”

Suggested analysis: The statement uses a personality label and does not identify evidence or an improvement measure. A better version is: “Ravi consistently meets project deadlines. In three of the last five project submissions, however, supporting test evidence was incomplete. Ravi should use the evidence checklist before submission; the target is 100% completeness over the next two months.”

Case 4: Choosing the Right Message Strategy

A department head must communicate four matters: approval of a training request, a routine request for monthly data, a proposal to purchase analytics software and refusal of a request for an additional budget.

Suggested analysis: Approval is a positive message; the monthly data request is routine or neutral; the software proposal is persuasive; and the budget refusal is a negative message. The writer should select the organization and tone separately for each message.

18. VTU Previous / Model Questions

The supplied Module 3 notes identify the following historical and model-paper questions. The labels below are retained from the source notes. These questions indicate recurring themes and are not predictions of the current examination.

Source identified in supplied notes	Question / topic	Marks
VTU 20MBA16 official model paper	Discuss the 3×3 writing process for business communication.	7
VTU 20MBA16 official model paper	What is the purpose of writing?	3
VTU 20MBA16 official model paper	What are persuasive letters?	3
VTU 20MBA16 official model paper	Draft a memo regarding a ban on cigarette smoking.	10
VTU 2016/17 indexed paper	What is written communication?	2
VTU 2016/17 indexed paper	Discuss the 3×3 writing process for business communication.	6
VTU 2016/17 indexed paper	Illustrate the principles of effective writing.	8
VTU 2016/17 indexed paper	What is the purpose of written communication?	3
VTU older indexed paper	Write a persuasive business letter convincing a customer to accept an improved, costlier product.	7

Question-paper caution: The questions are from earlier schemes or model papers as identified in the supplied notes. The current 2026 scheme and Course Code 3MBA106 syllabus take priority.

19. Additional Practice Questions

Marks	Practice questions
3	What is written communication?
3	What is the purpose of writing?
3	Define a persuasive letter.

3	What is audience analysis?
3	What is a business letter?
7	Explain the principles of effective writing with suitable examples.
7	Explain the 3×3 writing process.
7	Explain audience analysis and its importance in business writing.
7	Distinguish positive, neutral, persuasive and bad-news messages.
7	Explain the structure and features of a routine business letter.
7	Differentiate routine and persuasive letters.
10	Explain the 3×3 writing process with a neat diagram and example.
10	Discuss the principles of effective writing with suitable examples.
10	Explain direct and indirect approaches to bad-news messages.
10	Draft a persuasive business letter for a given situation.
10	Explain the types of business letters with examples.
10	Explain how employee reviews should be written effectively.
10	Draft a recommendation letter for an MBA student.
10	Draft a thank-you letter following a professional interaction.

20. Quick Revision Sheet

Topic	Memory anchor
Purpose of writing	Inform / persuade / obtain action / document / maintain goodwill.
Clarity	Reader understands without guessing; purpose, facts and action are clear.
Core writing principles	Accuracy + brevity + clarity; add simplicity, tone, audience orientation and emphasis.
3×3 process	Prewriting: Analyze–Anticipate–Adapt | Writing: Research–Organize–Draft | Revising: Edit–Proofread–Evaluate.
Audience analysis	Who? What do they know? What do they need? How may they react? Can they act? How much time do they have?
Positive / routine	Usually direct: main idea → details → action / close.
Persuasive	Reader need / problem → benefits and evidence → response to concerns → action.
Bad news	Choose direct or indirect based on audience and situation; give truthful reasons and protect goodwill.
Business letter	Sender details, date, receiver, subject, salutation, opening, body, closing, signature.
Types of letters	Inquiry, request, order, claim/adjustment, good-news, refusal, persuasive, recommendation, thank-you, employment-related.
Employee review	Evidence → strength → development area → action → measure.
Recommendation	Relationship/context → relevant capability → evidence → clear recommendation.
Thank-you	Specific appreciation → contribution/value → appropriate future connection.
Truth check	Tact is not deception; conciseness does not mean omitting necessary facts.

21. References and Scope Note

Primary conceptual reference identified in the supplied notes: P. D. Chaturvedi and Mukesh Chaturvedi, Business Communication: Skills, Concepts, and Applications, particularly Chapter 6 (Writing Skills) and Chapter 11 (Business Letters, Memos, and E-mails).

The 3×3 writing process and audience-planning framework in the supplied notes are attributed to Mary Ellen Guffey, Dana Loewy and Esther Griffin, Business Communication: Process & Product. The supplied edition presents prewriting (analyze, anticipate, adapt), drafting (research, organize, draft) and revising (edit, proofread, evaluate).

The supplied notes also identify Shruti D. Naik, Business Communication: A Practical Approach, and Raymond V. Lesikar and co-authors, Business Communication, as supplementary references.

The existing notes' conceptual organization and terminology have been retained. Explanations, sample messages, letter formats, comparisons and additional cases have been expanded to make the topics more complete. Examples are illustrative constructions, not quotations from the reference texts.

Syllabus basis: VTU MBA 2026 Scheme, Course Code 3MBA106, Semester I, Module 3 – Written Communication (9 teaching hours), as identified in the supplied notes.